# PROJECT DESIGN PHASE

## Problem–Solution Fit

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| **Date** | 11 October 2026 |
| **Team ID** | SWTID-2026-7837 |
| **Project Name** | Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer |

## 1. Problem Definition

The Standard Laptop Procurement process can require manual creation and assignment of a Catalog Task after a laptop request is approved. These manual steps can delay processing, reduce task visibility, create opportunities for errors, and make approved requests less consistent to process.

## 2. Proposed Solution

Use ServiceNow Flow Designer to automate the approval-to-task transition. When a Standard Laptop request is approved, the flow automatically creates a Catalog Task and assigns it to the Hardware team for configuration. The workflow integrates the Service Catalog, Requested Items, Approvals, Flow Designer, and Catalog Tasks.

## 3. Problem–Solution Fit Matrix

| Identified Problem | Project Requirement / Need | Proposed Solution | Fit |
|---|---|---|---|
| Manual Catalog Task creation after approval | Approved laptop requests need to progress without manual task creation. | Flow Designer automatically creates a Catalog Task after the Standard Laptop request is approved. | High |
| Manual task assignment | The task must reach the team responsible for laptop configuration. | Flow Designer assigns the generated Catalog Task to the Hardware team. | High |
| Delayed task visibility | The Hardware team needs a clear actionable work item promptly. | Automatic Catalog Task creation provides a visible work item immediately after the automated step. | High |
| Manual errors and inconsistent processing | Approved requests should follow a repeatable procurement workflow. | A defined Flow Designer workflow applies the same task creation and assignment logic. | High |
| Disconnected procurement stages | Service Catalog, approval, and hardware processing need a continuous workflow. | Service Catalog, Requested Item, Approval, Flow Designer, and Catalog Task are connected into an end-to-end process. | High |

## 4. Fit by User Interaction

| User / Stakeholder | Need | Solution Response | Expected Outcome |
|---|---|---|---|
| IT Procurement Requester | A predictable process after submitting a Standard Laptop request. | Approved requests automatically move to the next task stage. | Less manual follow-up and clearer process continuity. |
| Hardware Team | Receive the approved laptop request as an actionable work item. | Catalog Task is automatically created and assigned to the Hardware team. | Faster task visibility and prompt configuration start. |
| Process Owner | Consistent procurement processing with fewer manual steps. | Flow Designer standardizes Catalog Task creation and assignment. | Reduced manual errors and more consistent processing. |

## 5. Alignment with Project Objective

The proposed solution directly addresses the stated objective of streamlining IT hardware procurement. By automating Catalog Task creation and assignment after Standard Laptop approval, the solution removes manual coordination from the key transition point in the workflow. It supports consistent processing, improves task visibility, reduces delays, minimizes manual errors, and enables the Hardware team to begin configuration promptly.

## 6. Value Delivered

• Automation of Catalog Task creation after approval.

• Automatic assignment of the task to the Hardware team.

• Reduced manual intervention in the procurement workflow.

• Improved task visibility and processing continuity.

• Reduced opportunity for manual errors and delays.

• Simple end-to-end integration of request, approval, automation, and hardware task processing.

## 7. Conclusion

The Problem–Solution Fit is strong because each major problem identified in the Standard Laptop procurement process is directly addressed by a defined capability of the proposed ServiceNow Flow Designer solution. The solution remains focused on the stated project requirements and provides a practical automated path from approved request to Hardware team configuration task.